

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Asad Raja

Address: 9 Warren Avenue Cheam SM2 7QL

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: As someone who lives locally, I want to add my voice in support of planning application DM2025/01591. I think this proposal will be good for the neighbourhood.

The proposed works are modest: a part one, part two storey extension with a limited height increase to the existing building. There is no new upper floor that would create overlooking or overshadowing. The scheme includes external greening, cycle storage, and improved refuse arrangements, all of which improve the appearance of the site.

The Muslim community in Sutton has grown considerably and existing facilities are over-capacity. Many residents currently have to travel substantial distances by car to access suitable provision. A local facility at Dorset Road would meet a clear and demonstrable need.

Preventing health problems is cheaper and more effective than treating them. Community hubs that offer wellbeing activities, social connection, and educational programmes are proven to reduce demand on the NHS. This proposal delivers exactly that.

I would also note that this is not just a place of worship. The community hub element is open to all residents and will provide educational programmes, wellbeing sessions, social drop-ins, and interfaith activities. The benefits extend well beyond any single community.

The BNG assessment meets the statutory requirement, and the external greening will improve the appearance and ecological value of a site that currently offers very little in either regard. I welcome the environmental improvements included in this proposal.

DM2025/01591 is a strong application that will benefit the whole community. I ask the London Borough of Sutton to approve it.